



CASE STUDY

University of Florida Leverages Higher Ed Market Analysis to Strengthen Academic Programming

UF's Office for Strategic Initiatives partnered with Hanover to systematize its academic program development process with market analysis.



THE INSTITUTION

University of Florida Office for Strategic Initiatives

INSTITUTION TYPE

Public University

LOCATION

Gainesville, Florida

THE CHALLENGE

Create a streamlined and sustainable approach to academic program review

HANOVER SOLUTION

Data Analysis, Academic Program Assessment

The University of Florida's Office for Strategic Initiatives (OSI)

is dedicated to organizational innovation across the institution. With growing demands for comprehensive and timely market data to inform its academic programs, OSI leaders wanted to improve the process for conducting academic program market analysis. The office partnered with Hanover Research to tap into streamlined data and research tools that could determine the viability of new and existing degree programs.

THE CHALLENGE: ENHANCE HIGHER ED MARKET ANALYSIS CAPABILITIES ACROSS ACADEMIC CENTERS

Many of UF's academic programs require market analysis before they can launch. However, that work was often left to faculty or administrators who weren't trained in market research or delegated to costly consultants when funds were available. This led to an inconsistent market analysis product that lacked the depth to effectively drive decision-making processes.

OSI saw an opportunity to improve and streamline this process through its partnership with Hanover Research. Hanover would not only provide UF with new academic program data tools but also offer deep program portfolio expertise and recommendations based on the results of those datasets.

"At the University of Florida, we are required to complete a market analysis for most new academic programs to justify their creation and funding. Before Hanover built our dashboards, the only way we could get that kind of market analysis was by piecing it together ourselves, which was very time consuming."

— Jonathan Orsini, PhD
Director of Operations,
Office for Strategic Initiatives



55,211

The total number of enrolled students

Learn how to conduct a transparent, data-driven process that will help your institution make sound program decisions with our **A Step-by-Step Guide to Academic Portfolio Review.**

[Download the Guide](#)



THE SOLUTION: DASHBOARD TOOLS AND EXPERT ANALYSIS TO SPOT ACADEMIC PROGRAM DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Hanover's Academic Assessment Suite provided a one-stop platform that allowed OSI leaders to easily explore their existing academic program data and growth trends, uncover potential high-growth programs, and access detailed data related to the viability of specific proposals.

The dashboards and data visualization tools allow users to dynamically investigate a variety of market factors for any program area, without each department having to rely on different external consultants or time-intensive university resources to understand data related to:

- Student demand
- Labor market trends
- Online program search trends
- Competitive benchmarking comparisons

Moreover, Hanover's team worked closely with OSI to ensure the suite was customized to include all the data the university needed to consider and helped them interpret the data to provide rich program-level recommendations and considerations.



230+

The number of AI-related courses offered across the university

THE OUTCOME: AN EFFICIENT MARKET RESEARCH PROCESS TO BUILD MORE COMPETITIVE PROGRAMS

Hanover's academic program development guidance enabled OSI leaders to:

- Simplify UF's process and timing for program market analysis
- Conduct thorough research projects internally, reducing costs and time burdens
- Expand the range of data available to academic departments
- Equip faculty, administrators, and staff with an understanding of how students' online search behavior can affect program naming and positioning

With the right tools and support in place, the Office for Strategic Initiatives enhanced its ability to make informed, data-driven decisions about new academic programs that align with a rapidly changing market.

Looking forward, the Office for Strategic Initiatives will continue to develop the university's data analysis capabilities, and the dashboard features available through its partnership with Hanover Research.



16

The number of academic colleges and centers



300

The number of undergraduate and graduate degrees

“The combination of the program assessment dashboard and Hanover's expertise is insightful. Having multiple tools at our disposal makes our market analysis process easier and faster so we can make more informed decisions.”

—Jonathan Orsini, PhD
Director of Operations,
Office for Strategic Initiatives

Find out which high-growth programs are meeting today's labor market demands with our infographic,

Top Degrees on the Rise.

Download the Infographic

